

Physical form: 5 ft 8 in tall, 165 lbs, olive skin, green eyes, brown curly hair

Contact info:

Phone: (408) 857-0815

email: mzerella2@gmail.com

Personal Life, Character Traits, and Aspirations

- Places that I've lived and how I feel about them:
 - New York
 - Boston
 - San Jose
 - Los Gatos
 - Portland
 - Santa Cruz
 - Oakland
- Professional Personality Characteristics:
 - Sense of urgency
 - Deeply enjoy problem solving because it gives me a sense of accomplishment

SOCIAL LIFE:

TRAVEL:

ART:

CHOOSING TO BE FEARLESS:

PODCASTS:

My Favorite Things:

- Movie = Gladiator
- TV Show = Peaky Blinders
- Book = "The Subtle Art of Not Giving A Fuck" by Mark Manson
- Music Genre = Blues rock
- Song = "Better Now" by Collective Soul
- Band or Artist = The Red Hot Chili Peppers
- Color = Cerulean Blue
- Food = Baja-style fish tacos
- Dessert = Creme Brûlée
- Drink = Spicy cucumber margarita
- Animal = Capybara
- Sport = Rugby
- Sports Team = San Francisco 49ers
- Hobby = Playing Guitar
- Vacation Destination = Italy
- Season = Spring
- Holiday = Thanksgiving
- Actor/Actress = Ryan Reynolds
- Comedian = Bill Burr
- Cartoon Character = Hobbes from Calvin and Hobbes

- Superhero = Batman
- Video Game = Super Smash Bros
- Board Game = Chess
- Ice Cream Flavor = Salted Caramel
- Restaurant = Lago Di Como in Santa Cruz
- Fast Food Chain = In N Out Burger
- Clothing Brand = Vuori
- Sneaker Brand = Red Wings
- Car Brand = Audi
- Flower = Protea
- Tree = Giant Sequoia
- Movie Genre = Psychological Thriller
- TV Genre = Comedy
- Podcast = Modern Wisdom with Chris Williamson
- Workout Activity = Weightlifting
- Dance Style = Poorly
- Instrument = Guitar
- Painting or Art Style = Neoclassical
- Scent = Fresh baked cookies
- Quote = “He who has a why to live can bear almost any how” - Nietzsche
- Historical Figure = Giacomo Casanova
- Fictional Character =
- Fairy Tale = Shrek
- Place to Relax = The Beach
- Indoor Plant = Pothos vine
- Outdoor Activity = hiking
- Festival or Event = Northern Nights Music Festival
- Time of Day = Early morning
- App or Software
- Social Media Platform = Reddit
- Gadget = My computer
- Dessert Topping = whipped cream
- Sauce or Condiment = Tabasco sauce
- Type of Pasta = Fusili
- Sandwich = Meatball Sub
- Salad Dressing = Caesar dressing
- Cocktail = Margarita
- Coffee Type = Vietnamese style
- Tea Type = Yerba Mate
- Cheese = Mozzarella
- Snack Food = mixed nuts
- Breakfast Food = French omelette
- Pizza Topping = everything but the kitchen sink
- Cereal Brand = Captain Crunch
- Language = English
- Accent = Australian

- Weather = sunny and 75
- Ocean Animal = Octopus
- Bird = Scarlet Macaw
- Reptile = Komodo Dragon
- Bug/Insect = Honeybee
- Pet Breed = Siberian Husky
- Dance Move = The Worm
- Science Experiment = Putting mentos in a coke bottle
- Historical Era = The Renaissance
- Mythological Creature = Centaur
- Space Object (Planet, Star, etc.) = Black Hole
- Video Game Character = Charizard
- Comic Book = Calvin and Hobbes
- Fashion Accessory = Earrings
- Jacket or Coat Style = Bomber
- Interior Design Style = Art Deco
- Flower Scent = jasmine
- Beach = Sunny Cove in Santa Cruz, CA
- Mountain Range = Sierra Nevada
- City Skyline = New York City
- Amusement Park Ride = Top Gun
- Charity or Cause = Clean Energy

Guitar:

I started playing guitar at 7 years old, and it's been the longest, most consistent passion in my life. They say that learning a new language or a new instrument rewires your brain, and when I play the guitar, especially when I'm improvising or learning a new genre or song, I can definitely feel my brain stretching to accommodate it. Playing guitar has allowed me to stay mentally flexible over a long period of time, and I believe that the mental processes required to continually learn new music has carried over into every other area of my life as well. In addition to keeping me mentally sharp, playing guitar has allowed me to make many friends by playing with and for other people. It turns out that everyone likes someone who brings pleasant music with them. If I had a child, I would ensure that they played some sort of musical instrument, because it's the best decision that I've ever made. In fact, it was my parents who first encouraged me to play an instrument.

Playing guitar also taught me how easy it is to teach oneself something, and that epiphany has empowered me throughout my life. Whenever I feel mentally stagnant, I play guitar.

Music production:

I've started multiple music projects over the course of my life. None of them have met with any commercial success, but I am at peace with that. I played in bands throughout high school and college, and I've been involved with music projects off and on ever since. I'm always looking for other musicians to play and produce songs with. I truly started getting into music production during the Covid-19 pandemic when I started a band called Shotgun Octopus with my friend Taz. We produced and released 8 songs, and achieved some localized success and notoriety in the SF bay area. Eventually we disbanded, but we learned a lot about ourselves and about the music industry in the process.

- Music production is also a highly technical discipline, and teaching myself how to produce music was, while difficult initially, a great test of my intellect and perseverance and a much-needed reminder that I can tackle any problem and as long as I don't give up, I will eventually prevail.

Cooking:

Another one of my great passions is cooking. I've steadily grown better at cooking over the years, in fits and starts, and at this point I can confidently handle myself in the kitchen around a variety of types of

food. While I've learned many culinary techniques from my mother, I've slowly developed my own style and taught myself many of the techniques that I use day-to-day. The culinary arts is another area where I can push myself to continually learn more and every time I perfect a new technique or dish, it renews my confidence in myself. Similar to music, cooking has allowed me to make many friends over the years. People bond in a fundamental way over cooking and eating together; it's a sacrament, an integral component to our survival as a species.

Fitness & nutrition:

Staying fit has been a huge part of my life ever since I was a middle-schooler. I skipped a grade when we moved to California, and as a result I was a year younger and smaller than all the other kids. On top of that, I was nerdy and goofy, so I got picked on and bullied. Once I discovered wrestling and other sports, I learned that if I was strong and fast I could command respect on and off the field, and it became the bedrock on which my commitment to physical fitness and overall health has been built.

Now, as an adult, my motivation to stay fit is a combination of wanting to be attractive, healthy, and strong. I personally believe that consistent exercise, healthy diet, and the self confidence that stems from being able to look good in your clothes, can vastly improve any person's life.

Reading:

Reading is my oldest passion. According to my parents, I started reading full-length books quite early, between 4-5 years old, and I haven't stopped since. I go through periods where I read more or less, depending on the other influences in my life and how I have to allocate my time. I read predominantly non-fiction books, and my favorite subject matter are science and technology, economics, politics, and psychology. Second to hands-on learning, reading is my favorite way to teach myself new ideas and skills, and broadly serves to help demystify aspects of the changing world that are creating anxiety in many people, myself included. One of the pearls that I clutch close to my chest is my own skill in coming up with novel ideas, and books are the best way that I have to fuel that impetus.

Podcasts:

As much as I love reading, I have recently migrated my desire to learn to podcasts, as they allow me to keep in touch with the changing world in more bite-sized increments, and I can also listen to them while I drive or exercise.